

BrandGoblin AI: Customer Acquisition Plan

100 Active Users in 30 Days

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For Fox. Written July 5, 2026. Budget: \$300. Starting audience: zero.	1
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Customer Acquisition Plan: 100 Active Users in 30 Days

For Fox. Written July 5, 2026. Budget: \$300. Starting audience: zero.

Built from real research (sources at the bottom) plus your existing docs: NIX_MANIFESTO.md, CREATOR_PRO_GROWTH_ENGINE.md, NIX_TIKTOK_PLAYBOOK.md, NIX_CONTENT_AUTOMATION_PLAN.md. “Active user” means signed up AND generated at least one brand.

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: THE HONEST MATH

To get 100 active users, you need about 150 signups, because not everyone who signs up will finish a brand. Industry data says AI products activate around 55% of signups on average (PM Toolkit benchmarks). BrandGoblin should beat that, because the whole product IS the activation moment (type an idea, get a brand). Target: 65% activation. 150 signups x 65% = about 98 active users. That is the goal line.

Where the 150 signups come from (conservative to optimistic range):

Channel	Signups	Cost	Why this number
Reddit + community posts	40 to 60	\$0	Case study: one good post = 12,000 visitors and 47 signups in 48 hours. You will make 8 to 12 quality posts over 30 days. Most will do little. One or two will hit.
Launch platforms (Unneed, Microlaunch, Product Hunt, etc.)	25 to 40	\$0	Products listed on 3+ platforms get 2.8x the traffic of Product Hunt alone. Each launch is a small spike.
Free AI directories (10+ listings)	10 to 20	\$0	Passive, compounding. TAAFT alone gets 2M+ visitors/month of people specifically hunting AI tools.
Short-form video (TikTok, Reels, Shorts), static Nix + screen demos	15 to 30	\$0	Unpredictable by nature. Cal AI pattern: the visual “wow” of the product doing its thing IS the content. You are farming for one hit.
TikTok Spark Ads boosting your single best video (weeks 3-4 only)	20 to 40	\$150	Spark Ads run \$0.10 to \$0.30 per click. \$150 = roughly 500 to 1,500 clicks to a free, no-card product. Even at a modest 4% visitor-to-signup rate that is 20 to 60 signups.
Total	110 to 190	\$150	Midpoint about 150 signups = about 100 active users.

Secondary goal, free to Pro: freemium benchmarks say 2 to 5% of free users convert to paid, and it usually takes weeks, not days. Realistic month 1 target: **3 to 8 Pro subscribers** (\$57 to \$152 MRR). That sounds small. It is normal. The Growth Engine doc already has the right levers

(paywall at peak emotion, energy-out upsell, dunning); this plan adds email nudges and one small in-app tweak.

The plan in one sentence: spend weeks 1-2 planting free seeds everywhere (communities, directories, launches, daily video), spend weeks 3-4 watering whatever sprouted, and only spend money to amplify a video that already proved itself organically.

2. WHAT THE RESEARCH SAYS (findings summary)

How tools actually get their first 100 users now. Not from one big launch. Founders getting early users in 2025-2026 do multi-platform seeding: Reddit posts, niche communities, directories, small launch platforms, and consistent short-form content. One founder's transparent breakdown: "Reddit + Indie Hackers threads beat Product Hunt for early users (3 to 8x more signups from honest updates)." Cold outreach and reacting fast to early user feedback also showed up repeatedly as what worked. What was a waste of time: waiting for one perfect launch, buying upvote pods, and paid ads before the product's message was proven. (Sources: Indie Hackers threads, Luka, OneUp case study.)

Product Hunt in 2026: worth doing, worth nothing extra. 500+ daily submissions, pay-to-play consultants, brutal odds for a no-audience solo founder. BUT it still gives a traffic spike, a badge, early-adopter feedback, and a permanent listing. Verdict from multiple 2026 sources: launch there as ONE stop on a multi-platform tour, spend one day on it, not 50 hours. (Puthusu, Calmops, DEV Community.)

Better small launch platforms exist. Uneed and Microlaunch limit daily launches so small products actually get seen. BetaList can drive 500 to 2,000 email signups but the free queue is slow (paid skip is \$129, not worth your \$300). Multi-platform listing beats any single launch. (LaunchList, Superframeworks, Uneed blog.)

AI directories are free, passive traffic. There's An AI For That (2M+ monthly visitors, high intent), Futurepedia, Toolify (29k+ tools listed), and dozens more with free submission. Bonus: AI assistants like ChatGPT crawl these directories when people ask "what tool makes a brand for me," so listings compound. (ListMyAI, best-of-ai GitHub list.)

Short-form video: the product demo IS the winning format. Cal AI grew to millions in revenue on the back of one highly filmable moment (scan food, get calories). BrandGoblin has the same shape: type a dumb idea, watch a full brand appear. Data points that matter: the first 3 seconds decide everything (videos holding 70%+ of viewers past 3 seconds get 2.2x or more total views); videos under 15 seconds hit about 92% completion; raw phone-shot content beats polished ads 3 to 5x on conversion metrics; 73% of e-commerce video ads fail in the first 3 seconds because they look like ads. Your TikTok Playbook already encodes all of this correctly. (Stormy AI, TTS Vibes, inBeat, Stackmatix.)

Mascots genuinely outperform, with real numbers. Campaigns with a mascot are 37% more likely to grow market share (IPA research), mascots beat celebrity ads on recall and appeal (3.7 vs 2.8 stars in 2025 Super Bowl testing), and Duolingo's owl tripled the user base since 2021 with low-production, personality-first content. Important nuance for you: Duolingo's wins came from personality and humor, NOT animation quality. Their best content is a person in a cheap costume being funny. (Adweek, DesignRush, Brand24.)

Paid ads on \$300. TikTok minimums: about \$50/day campaign level, \$20/day ad group. Reddit ads have a \$5/day minimum but sources agree the algorithm needs about \$50/day to optimize, so \$300 total gets wasted there. Meta on \$300 with zero pixel data is a coin flip. The one small-budget format with evidence behind it: TikTok Spark Ads (boosting an existing organic post from your own account). Spark Ads get 30% higher engagement and up to 57% lower cost per acquisition than regular ads, at \$0.10 to \$0.30 per click, because they do not look like ads. The catch: you should only boost a post that already performed organically. Verdict: \$0 spent until a video earns it. (Trackbee, Stackmatix, Recho, Conbersa.)

Freemium conversion benchmarks. Free-to-paid averages 2 to 5% (good), 8%+ is great. Activation below 20% is weak, above 40% is strong, AI tools average about 55%. Users who hit the “aha” in under 10 minutes activate at dramatically higher rates. 90% of users churn if they do not see value in week 1, and lifecycle email is the cheapest fix. Reverse trials beat plain freemium 2 to 3x, which your Growth Engine doc already planned, though the newer APP_FREEMIUM_CONVERSION_BRIEF moved you to a lasting free tier. Keep the lasting free tier for this month; it is better for a growth push because “free forever, no card” is the strongest possible ad copy. (First Page Sage, ChartMogul, Userpilot, UserGuiding, PM Toolkit.)

Referral programs: too early. Evidence is consistent that formal give-get referral programs launched before product-market fit see poor participation and waste build time. BUT the passive Loom-style loop (every share carries the brand and a link) works from day one because it costs the user nothing. You already built this: the watermark on shared creations and the showcase wall. Keep them, polish nothing, build no referral program this month. (Friendbuy, GrowSurf, Loom PLG case studies.)

Community rules matter. The 90/10 rule keeps you unbanned: 90% of your Reddit activity should be genuinely helping people, 10% can mention your product. Subs like r/Entrepreneur ban direct promo entirely; r/SideProject welcomes it; r/smallbusiness allows posts tagged [Promo]. Exact sub-by-sub playbook is in section 4. (OneUp, Redship, KarmaGuy, SaaSCity.)

What to skip and why (quick list): - Reddit ads and Meta ads: budget too small for their algorithms to learn. - BetaList paid (\$129): wrong buyer for you (startup scene, not side hustlers), and it eats half the budget. - Building a referral program: evidence says wait until people already love it. - Long-form SEO/blog content: compounds in months 3-12, does nothing in 30 days. - Cold email: wrong fit for a \$19 consumer-ish product, high effort per user.

3. THE HONEST NIX RIG VERDICT

Is the animated Nix rig essential to hit 100 users in 30 days? No.

Here is the evidence-based reasoning, straight:

1. **Mascot marketing works, but not because of animation.** The research is genuinely strong that characters beat faceless brands (37% more likely to gain market share, beats celebrities on recall). But every breakout example wins on PERSONALITY, not rigging. Duolingo’s most viral content is a costume and good writing. The mascot advantage is “a character people recognize and love,” and a static Nix with a great voice already delivers that.
2. **The highest-converting format for a tool like yours does not need Nix to move.** The Cal AI pattern (show the magic moment on screen, raw and fast) is what converts viewers

into signups. That is a screen recording of the app with a hook. Nix appears as static art, stickers, and reaction cutaways. UGC-style raw content beats polished content 3 to 5x anyway, so a half-polished animation could actually perform WORSE than a static Nix pop-in with your voiceover.

3. What static Nix captures right now (most of the value):

- Static Nix PNG pop-ins and zooms over screen-recorded demos (CapCut does this in minutes).
 - Your voiceover AS Nix reacting to brands he generates. Your voice skills are the real unfair asset here, not the rig.
 - Nix “slideshow” content: image posts and carousels perform on TikTok too.
 - The existing image-to-video tools in your automation plan can add subtle motion (blinks, sways) to the real Nix art without the Character Animator rig.
4. **Keep building the rig in parallel, guilt-free.** It is a compounding asset (Founder Rule from the Manifesto: every hour should create an asset). When it lands, it upgrades a machine that is already running. It must never be the reason a video did not ship today.

Verdict in one line: personality now, puppetry later. The rig is a week-8 amplifier, not a week-1 requirement.

4. THE 30-DAY PLAN

The shape of the month

- **Week 1: Plant.** Fix the funnel basics, list everywhere free, post the first videos, start Reddit karma-building.
 - **Week 2: Launch tour.** Uneed, Microlaunch, and friends. First real Reddit value posts. Daily video continues.
 - **Week 3: Product Hunt + double down.** PH launch mid-week. Boost the best video with Spark Ads if one has earned it.
 - **Week 4: Amplify and convert.** Keep ads on the winner, reply-to-comment video loop, push free users toward Pro.
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WEEK 1, DAY BY DAY

Day 1 (Monday): Funnel check. Nothing else matters if this leaks. - Go through the new-user path yourself in an incognito window: landing page, sign up, generate a brand, share. Time it. The research says users who hit the wow in under 10 minutes activate at far higher rates. Yours should be under 3. - Make sure the share button and watermark work, and the public showcase wall has at least 6 great-looking brands on it (make them yourself with fun ideas if needed: a hot sauce brand, a dog bakery, a candle shop). Empty walls kill trust. - Set up tracking so you can answer, every day: how many signups, how many generated a brand, where they came from. Even a simple UTM link scheme works: give every channel its own link (brandgoblinai.com/?ref=reddit, ?ref=tiktok, ?ref=uneed, and so on). A UTM is just a tag on the end of a link that tells your analytics where the click came from. - Kill any leftover placeholder testimonials (the Growth Engine doc flagged these). One fake quote found by a Redditor can nuke a launch.

Day 2 (Tuesday): Directory blitz, part 1. Submit BrandGoblin to these free directories. Each takes 10 to 20 minutes: logo, one-liner, description, screenshots, link. Write ONE great description first, then paste everywhere. Use each site's submit page: - There's An AI For That: <https://theresanaiforthat.com> (biggest, 2M+ monthly visitors, free tier) - Futurepedia: <https://www.futurepedia.io> - Toolify: <https://www.toolify.ai> - AI Tools Directory: <https://aitoolsdirectory.com> - TopAI.tools: <https://topai.tools> - Insidr AI tools: <https://www.insidr.ai/ai-tools/> - Description to reuse: "BrandGoblin AI turns one sentence into a complete brand in under 2 minutes: name, tagline, story, colors, website copy, social content, and launch plan. Then Goblin Studio generates real logos and social graphics. Free to start, no credit card."

Day 3 (Wednesday): Directory blitz, part 2, plus Reddit prep. - Work through the community-maintained mega-list at <https://github.com/best-of-ai/ai-directories> and submit to another 5 to 10 free ones. Diminishing returns after the top 10, so cap the time at 2 hours. - Create or dust off your Reddit account. Join these subs and just READ today: r/SideProject, r/SaaS, r/EntrepreneurRideAlong, r/smallbusiness, r/sidehustle, r/EtsySellers, r/shopify, r/Entrepreneur, r/AlphaAndBetaUsers, r/roastmystartup. - Leave 5 to 10 genuinely helpful comments (branding questions, naming questions, "how do I look professional on no budget" threads). Zero product mentions. This builds karma and account age so your later posts do not get auto-filtered. The rule from the research: 90% helping, 10% promoting, forever.

Day 4 (Thursday): First videos ship. Shoot and post the first 2 videos from the TikTok Playbook starter slate, adapted for static Nix: - Video 1 (the money format): screen recording of the app. Hook text on frame 1: "I gave this AI goblin my dumbest business idea." Show the prompt going in, cut to the reveal montage (name, colors, logo art appearing), static Nix PNG slides in at the end with your Nix voice: "Next." Under 15 seconds. Post to TikTok, then reuse the same file for Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts (one shoot, three platforms, per your automation plan). - Video 2 (the comment loop starter): "Comment a business idea and Nix will brand it." This is the engine from your Playbook; every comment becomes a future video. - Bio link on all three profiles: the app link with ?ref=tiktok / ?ref=ig / ?ref=yt tags. Pin a comment with the link on every video.

Day 5 (Friday): First community shares (the friendly rooms). - Post to r/SideProject. This sub welcomes launches. Format that works there: honest builder story, not an ad. Title: "I built an AI that turns one sentence into a full brand kit (name, colors, logo, launch plan). Solo founder, would love brutal feedback." Include 2 to 3 screenshots of a finished brand. Reply to every single comment within the hour (early engagement is a ranking signal on Reddit too). - Post the same (reworded, never copy-paste) to r/AlphaAndBetaUsers and r/roastmystartup. Roast threads are underrated: the feedback is real and the visibility is free. - Create your product page on Indie Hackers (<https://www.indiehackers.com>) and write a short first post: what you built, the 30-day goal, the numbers so far. Build-in-public updates there outperformed Product Hunt for early users in multiple 2026 founder reports.

Day 6 (Saturday): Video days continue, X presence starts. - Post video 3: before/after format. Hook: "POV: you have a business idea but can't afford a designer." Napkin-scribble idea on screen, then the full kit reveal. This before/after transformation is one of the proven converting formats from the research. - Set up the X account. First post: the 30-day challenge itself. "Day 6: I'm a solo founder trying to get 100 users for my AI brand generator in 30 days with \$300. Current count: X. Following along?" A public scoreboard is a story people follow; the saturation research says generic build-in-public is dead but a concrete, honest challenge with numbers still works.

Day 7 (Sunday): Batch and breathe. - Batch-produce next week's videos in one session (your automation plan's exact recommendation): 5 to 7 clips, mix of demo/wow (most), one Nix-personality clip, one founder clip. - Reply to all comments everywhere. Log the week's numbers on the scorecard (section 7). - Prep launch assets for week 2: 3 to 5 clean screenshots, a 30 to 60 second demo video (reuse your best TikTok), the one-liner, and a 2 to 3 sentence description. Every launch platform asks for the same kit.

WEEK 2: THE LAUNCH TOUR (Days 8 to 14)

One platform per day, so each gets real attention and you can reply to comments all day:

- **Day 8: Unneed** (<https://www.unneed.best>). Limits daily launches so small products get seen. Free. Schedule it, then spend the day replying.
 - **Day 9: Microlaunch** (<https://microlaunch.net>). Built for indie/micro-SaaS, small but genuinely engaged community.
 - **Day 10: Fazier** (<https://fazier.com>) and Tiny Startups (<https://www.tinystartups.com>). Both indie-friendly, both free.
 - **Day 11: StartupBase** (<https://startupbase.io>) and Peerlist Launchpad (<https://peerlist.io/launchpad>).
 - **Day 12: The big Reddit swing.** By now your account has karma and a week of helpful comments. Post to r/smallbusiness with the [Promo] tag (allowed there, per their rules): "Made a free tool that builds your whole brand identity in 2 minutes. No card needed. Would love feedback from real business owners." Same day, look for the weekly promo/feedback threads in r/SaaS ("Share Your SaaS") and r/Entrepreneur (promo is ONLY allowed in their weekly thread; a direct post there gets you banned).
 - **Day 13: Helpful-first posts in the seller subs.** r/EtsySellers and r/shopify do not allow self-promo posts. The move: find people asking branding/logo questions and answer them genuinely and completely, with the tool as a PS if rules allow it, or only when someone asks "what did you use." Slow burn, right audience. Never drop links unprompted in these two.
 - **Day 14: Facebook groups, carefully.** Join 3 to 4 e-commerce/Etsy seller groups (from research: "Shopify Entrepreneurs" 100k+, "Ecom Queens" 50k, "Ecommerce Entrepreneurs" 50k, plus one Etsy sellers group). Week 1 rule: introduce yourself, help, no links. Most groups ban immediate promo. Also: keep daily video posting through all of this. The comment-loop videos ("you asked, Nix branded it") should be flowing by now.
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WEEK 3: PRODUCT HUNT + FIRST DOLLARS SPENT (Days 15 to 21)

Product Hunt launch: aim for Tuesday or Wednesday (Days 16-17). The 2026 consensus: worth one focused day as part of the tour, not a life goal. Checklist: - [] Create the launch a week ahead so people can "notify me." - [] Assets: logo (240x240), gallery of 4 to 6 screenshots, your best 30-second demo video first in the gallery. - [] Tagline under 60 characters: "A full brand from one sentence, in 2 minutes." - [] First comment from you (the maker comment): the honest solo-founder story, what it does, what is free, and a direct ask for feedback. Write it the night before. - [] Launch at 12:01 AM Pacific (the PH day runs midnight to midnight Pacific; early hours matter for ranking). - [] Tell your (small but real by now) X, Indie Hackers, and TikTok audiences. Never ask for upvotes directly (against PH rules); say "we're live on Product Hunt today, come say hi." - [] Reply to every comment all day. - [] Do NOT pay any "launch service"

or upvote pod. The research is blunt: it is against the rules, it is detectable, and it kills credibility.

- Expectation setting: with no audience, top 10 is unlikely and fine. You are here for the listing, the badge, some early adopters, and the backlink.

Spark Ads decision (Day 18): the \$300 question. Look at your videos so far. The bar, from the research: pick a video with above-average completion for your account, engagement at least 1.5x your median, and a story that works for a stranger. If one clears the bar: - Boost it as a TikTok Spark Ad from your own account. Budget: \$25/day for 6 days (\$150). Objective: traffic/clicks to the app link. Spark Ads get up to 57% lower cost per acquisition than normal ads because they look native. - Expected at \$0.10 to \$0.30 per click: roughly 500 to 1,500 visits. At even 4% signup, 20 to 60 signups. - If NO video has earned it yet: spend \$0, keep posting. The evidence says boosting a mediocre post is burning money. The remaining \$150 stays in reserve either way (see section 5).

Rest of week 3: keep the daily video + comment-loop cadence, second wave of value posts in the seller subs and Facebook groups (by now you are a known helpful member; soft mentions are earned), and post your PH results honestly on Indie Hackers and X (“here’s exactly what Product Hunt got me”), which itself is a proven content format.

WEEK 4: AMPLIFY AND CONVERT (Days 22 to 30)

- Keep the Spark Ad running on the winner if cost per click stays under about \$0.50; kill it if not.
- Double down on whichever organic channel the scorecard says is winning. Make 3x more of exactly that. This is the whole game: weeks 1-3 were experiments, week 4 is exploitation.
- Reply-to-comment video machine at full speed: every “brand my idea” comment is a free, personalized video that proves the product AND flatters the commenter into sharing it.
- Free-to-Pro push (see section 6): the email nudges go out this week to everyone who activated but has not upgraded.
- Days 29-30: write the honest recap (“I tried to get 100 users in 30 days with \$300, here’s every number”) and post it to r/SideProject, Indie Hackers, and X. Win or lose, transparent recaps are among the highest-performing posts in these communities, and it seeds month 2.

THE HOOK BANK (ready to use, tailored to BrandGoblin)

First-frame text or first spoken line. All follow the proven patterns (identity call, transformation, curiosity, challenge):

1. “POV: you have a business idea but can’t afford a designer.”
2. “I gave this AI goblin my dumbest business idea. Watch.”
3. “This is what \$0 and 2 minutes gets you instead of a \$5,000 agency.”
4. “Comment a business idea and Nix will brand it. I’m not kidding.”
5. “Watch an entire brand get built before your coffee cools.”
6. “Your Etsy shop looks homemade. Here’s the 2-minute fix.”
7. “I asked AI to brand ‘a candle shop for people who hate candles.’”
8. “Nobody talks about how expensive LOOKING legit is. So I fixed it.”
9. “Rating the brands my goblin made from your comments. Part 1.”

10. “If you’ve been sitting on a business idea since January, this is your sign.”
11. “A designer quoted me \$3,000. A goblin did it in 118 seconds.”
12. “Day 12 of trying to get 100 users for my goblin app. Here’s what happened.”
13. “Free tool. No card. Full brand. There’s no catch and it’s freaking people out.”
14. “The name, the logo, the colors, the launch plan. One sentence in. Watch.”

Format rules (from your Playbook, confirmed by 2025-2026 data): payoff in the first 3 seconds, under 15 seconds total, on-screen keywords burned into frame 1, trending or original sound, soft CTA in caption and pinned comment, never a hard sell in the video. Roughly 80% entertainment/wow, 20% direct “try it.”

5. THE \$300 BUDGET

Item	Amount	When	Why
TikTok Spark Ads on your single best organic video	\$150	Week 3, only if a video earns it	The only paid format with small-budget evidence behind it (57% lower CPA, \$0.10 to \$0.30 clicks, feels native). Boosting proven content, not gambling on cold creative.
Reserve / second boost	\$100	Week 4	If the first boost works (cost per signup under \$5), feed the winner. If not, hold it for month 2.
Small tools/assets buffer (CapCut Pro month, a scheduler like Metricool free tier going paid, or a directory skip-the-line fee if one is under \$30 like Unneed’s)	\$50	As needed	Removes friction from the content machine, which is the real engine.

The \$0 option is legitimate. The evidence supports it: every organic channel in section 1’s table works without ads, and the honest range without ads is still 90 to 150 signups. If no video earns a boost by day 18, spend nothing and roll the full \$300 into month 2 when you will have proven creative. Reddit ads and Meta ads are explicitly out: their algorithms need \$50/day to learn, which your budget cannot feed.

6. FREE-TO-PRO PLAYS (small, since dev time competes with marketing time)

Benchmarks first so expectations are sane: 2 to 5% of free users going paid is normal and GOOD, and it rarely happens in the first session. From 150 signups, 3 to 8 Pro conversions this month is a win. The levers, in effort order:

1. **Energy-out moment (mostly built already).** Per APP_FREEMIUM_CONVERSION_BRIEF, when the free 250 Creative Energy runs out, the user sees the upgrade/top-up nudge. Make sure that screen shows WHAT they would be able to keep making (their own brand's art, not generic promises) and both paths: Pro \$19/mo and the \$19 top-up. Peak-emotion paywalls beat cold pricing pages, per your own Growth Engine doc and the activation research.
2. **The 3-email nudge sequence (build this week, it is tiny).** Research: 90% of users churn without value in week 1, and lifecycle email is the cheapest retention/conversion tool that exists.
 - Email 1, right after first brand: "Your brand [Name] is live. Here are the 3 assets people make next" with direct links back in.
 - Email 3 days later: "One idea, three brands. Pro users test names side by side" plus a great showcase example.
 - Email 7 days later: "Your Creative Energy: [X] left. Here's what Pro unlocks" with the upgrade link.
 - Any simple sender works (Resend, Loops, even Supabase functions). Keep it plain text, from "Fox at BrandGoblin," human voice.
3. **Dunning (from the Growth Engine doc, still the highest-ROI config change).** Turn on Stripe Smart Retries and failed-payment emails. 20 to 40% of SaaS churn is failed cards, not real cancels. One day of setup, permanent payback.
4. **Do NOT build this month:** annual plans, Launch Kit tier, referral program, save-the-cancel flow. All good ideas from the Growth Engine doc, all sequenced for after you have users to convert. Acquisition is the constraint right now.

7. KPIs AND THE DAILY SCORECARD

Track these 6 numbers daily. Five minutes, same time every day. A simple note or spreadsheet is fine:

Metric	How to get it	30-day target	Daily pace check
Signups	Supabase users count	150	~5/day average (expect lumpy: launch days spike)
Activated (made 1+ brand)	generation logs	100	65% of signups, watch this ratio hardest
Traffic by source	UTM tags / analytics	n/a	Tells you where to double down

Metric	How to get it	30-day target	Daily pace check
Video views + 3-sec retention	TikTok/IG/YT analytics	1 video over 10k views	Retention over 60% = boost candidate
Shares/watermarked creations shared	share button events	50	The passive loop's pulse
Pro conversions	Stripe	3 to 8	Any week-1 conversion is a bonus, not a plan

Weekly review (Sundays): which channel produced the most ACTIVATED users per hour of your time? Next week, that channel gets double the hours. That single loop is the whole strategy.

Red flags to act on immediately: - Activation under 50%: stop marketing for a day and fix onboarding. You are filling a leaky bucket. - A community post removed: read the sub's rules again, message the mods politely, never repost the same thing. - Spark Ad cost per click over \$0.50 for 2 days: kill it.

8. WHAT NOT TO DO IN THE FIRST 30 DAYS

1. **Do not wait for the Nix rig.** Verdict is in section 3. It ships when it ships; the machine runs without it.
2. **Do not run Meta or Reddit ads.** \$300 cannot feed their learning phases; it will vanish with nothing to show.
3. **Do not buy upvotes, pods, or “launch services.”** Against every platform's rules, detectable, and one accusation in the comments poisons the launch.
4. **Do not build the referral program.** Evidence says pre-love referral programs flop. The watermark loop already covers passive sharing.
5. **Do not write SEO blog posts.** Compounds in months, useless in 30 days.
6. **Do not spam link-drops in r/EtsySellers, r/shopify, r/Entrepreneur.** These bans are permanent and these are your best long-term audiences. Helpful-only there this month.
7. **Do not add product features** beyond the tiny conversion items in section 6. The Mani-festo's own filter applies: acquisition, conversion, retention. Everything else waits.
8. **Do not chase 10 platforms with videos.** One shoot posts to TikTok + Reels + Shorts. That is the whole video footprint.
9. **Do not obsess over Pro conversions in week 1-2.** The benchmark math says conversions follow activation by days or weeks. Panic-discounting early helps nobody.
10. **Do not compare against Looka's scale.** Positioning note: Looka (\$20 to \$129/yr, 20M+ users) and Brandmark (\$25 to \$175 one-time) sell LOGOS with brand kits attached, and their common complaints are generic output and billing/refund friction. BrandGoblin's counter-position, use it everywhere: complete brand (story, copy, content, launch plan, not just a logo), 2 minutes, actually free to try with no card, and a personality (Nix) instead of a form. You will not out-scale them this month. You can out-charm and out-complete them in every video and every listing description.

9. SOURCES

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